

Sales Performance Dashboard

Portfolio-ready analysis report | Excel dashboard case study

BUSINESS INTELLIGENCE • SALES ANALYSIS			
2,297,201 TOTAL SALES	2,116,697 NET SALES	5,009 ORDERS	793 CUSTOMERS
180,504 RETURNS	297,687 DISCOUNTS	1,555,845 COGS	7.9% RETURN RATE

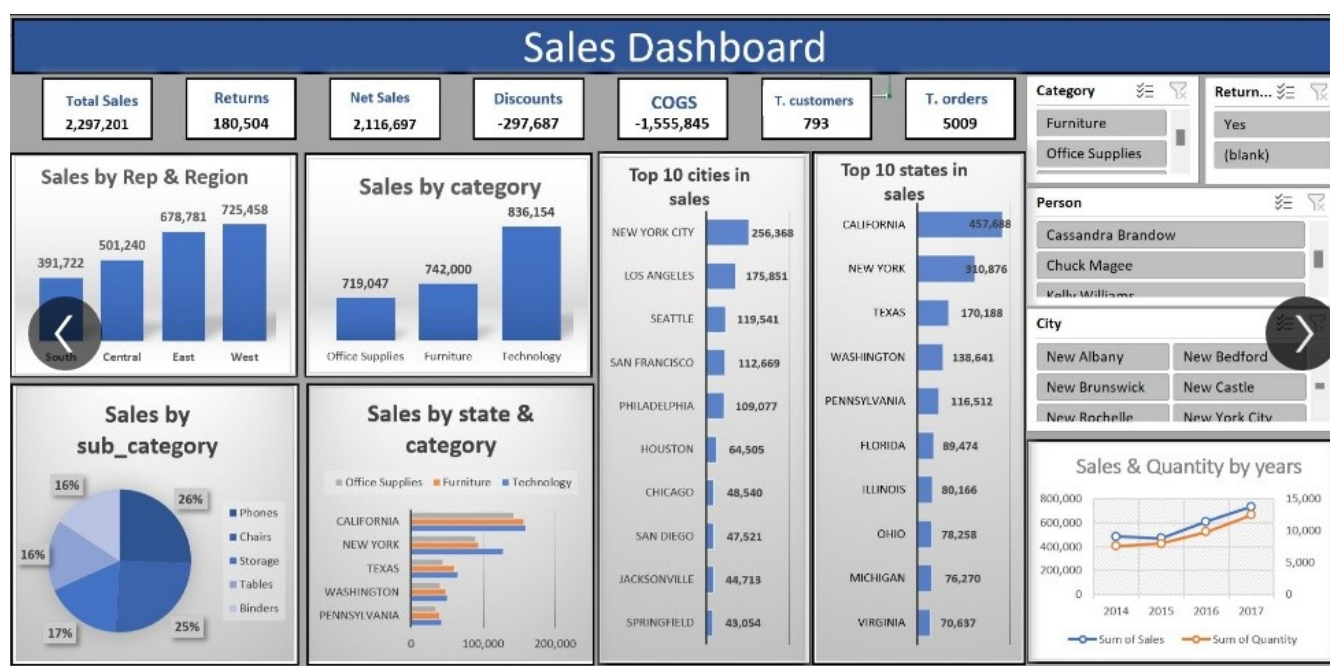


Figure 1. Interactive sales dashboard with filters by category, return status, salesperson, and city.

Business question

Which regions, product categories, states, and cities generate the strongest sales performance, and how do returns and discounts affect net sales?

Project outcome

A single interactive dashboard that converts transaction-level data into comparable sales, return, customer, order, and geographic performance indicators.

Analysis and Key Findings

The analysis covered 5,009 orders from 793 customers. Total sales reached 2,297,201, while returns of 180,504 reduced net sales to 2,116,697. The return value represented 7.9% of gross sales, and recorded discounts were equivalent to 13.0% of total sales.

Area	Result	Business interpretation
Regional performance	West: 725,458; East: 678,781; Central: 501,240; South: 391,722	The West led the business and generated 85.2% more sales than the South, indicating a material regional performance gap.
Category mix	Technology: 836,154; Furniture: 742,000; Office Supplies: 719,047	Technology was the largest category, contributing 36.4% of total sales.
State concentration	California: 457,688; New York: 310,876	The two leading states generated 33.5% of total sales, showing meaningful geographic concentration.
Leading cities	New York City: 256,368; Los Angeles: 175,851	The two highest-performing cities were clear priority markets for retention and targeted growth.
Time trend	Sales and quantity increased overall from 2014 to 2017	The trend supports continued growth monitoring, while year-level drill-down is needed to identify the specific drivers.

Headline insight

The strongest defensible insight is the regional gap: West sales were approximately 85% higher than South sales. This gives management a clear question to investigate - whether the gap is driven by customer demand, sales coverage, product mix, pricing, or channel execution.

Supporting calculations

Metric	Calculation	Result
Return rate	$180,504 \div 2,297,201$	7.9%
Discount share	$297,687 \div 2,297,201$	13.0%
Average sales per order	$2,297,201 \div 5,009$	458.61
Average net sales per order	$2,116,697 \div 5,009$	422.58
Orders per customer	$5,009 \div 793$	6.3

Method, Contribution, and Recommendations

Workflow

- Imported and prepared the raw sales data using Power Query before analysis.
- Selected the core business KPIs: total sales, returns, net sales, discounts, COGS, customers, and orders.
- Built PivotTables and PivotCharts for region, category, sub-category, state, city, and annual trend analysis.
- Added interactive slicers to allow users to filter the dashboard by category, return status, salesperson, and city.
- Reviewed the dashboard outputs and translated the strongest comparisons into business findings.

My contribution

I completed the data preparation, selected the KPIs, created the analytical views, designed the dashboard layout, and interpreted the results. The project demonstrates the ability to move from raw records to an interactive management view and explain what the numbers mean for decision-making.

Business recommendations

- Investigate the South region to determine whether lower sales are caused by account coverage, product availability, pricing, or weaker demand.
- Protect growth in the West and East while testing targeted actions that can transfer successful practices to lower-performing regions.
- Review the return rate and discount share by category and salesperson, because high sales can still produce weak value if returns and discounting are concentrated.
- Prioritize Technology for growth planning, while checking whether its return rate, margin, and COGS profile support the same conclusion.
- Use California and New York as priority markets, but monitor concentration risk and identify the next tier of states and cities for expansion.

Limitations and next analysis

The dashboard provides sales and operational comparisons, but the screenshot does not expose product-level profitability, order-level margin, or the detailed causes of returns. A stronger next version would calculate profit after discounts and returns, compare return rates across categories, and identify the customer or product segments responsible for the largest value leakage.

Portfolio summary

Built an interactive Excel sales dashboard for 5,009 orders, revealing an 85.2% sales gap between the highest- and lowest-performing regions and highlighting Technology, California, and New York City as the leading category, state, and city.